Movement and Exclusion

Opening the Door on Threshold Spaces in the *Pyramid Texts*.

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Abstract.

Across cultures, doors and threshold spaces are symbolically linked to ideas of transition, transgression, and liminality. In the ancient Egyptian Old Kingdom, references to these types of spaces come predominantly from administrative and mortuary literature and, in particular, from the *Pyramid Texts* of the 5th and 6th Dynasties. The present study originated from the ongoing debate in the field of *Pyramid Text* studies that focuses on how the corpus should be "read" and how such readings influence our understanding of the ontological transformation of the deceased king or queen in the afterlife. A significant aspect of this "reading" concerns the purpose of threshold spaces within *Pyramid Text* spells, how we interpret them, and how we assess their relationship with the surrounding tomb architecture. Through the theoretical lens of liminality, this study analyses key threshold terms extant in the *Pyramid Text* corpus, and explores their relationship to ancient Egyptian royal and elite ideologies of purity, the endurance of cult, and broader notions of spatial and social control. This study fundamentally questions the adaptive scholarly interpretation of certain texts within the corpus, and how the threshold spaces within have been used to justify textual-spatial correlations, demonstrating that such "readings" are untenable.

This thesis consists of two thematic parts. The first, "Movement", explores the terminology used within the corpus to express a doorway or threshold space. Utilising archaeological records and extant administrative and mortuary data, the chapters in this section re-examine each of these terms individually, situating them within the wider context of Old Kingdom social and religious use. The second part of this study, "Exclusion," examines terminology associated with spatial restriction. Through a close analysis of contemporary threat-formulae and elite ideologies of social and religious purity and control, the chapters in this section explore how we interpret liminal exclusion, and what the "Othering" of certain socio-cultural groups reveals about elite Egyptian conceptions of this world and the next.

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Source and Location Codes.

Navigation of the current *Pyramid Text* literature is complicated by the differing source and location sigla provided by individuals and organisations. The most comprehensive sources for analysing the spatial placement of the texts, Allen's *A New Concordance of the Pyramid Texts* (2013) and the comprehensive *Les Textes de La Pyramides de Pepy Ier* (2018) produced by Mathieu and the Mission Archéologique Française de Saqqara (MafS), use differing citation systems not only for the numbering of texts, but for the designation of spell placement. In order to simplify this, the system of identification used within this work will be based primarily on the source and location codes adhered to by Allen. Accordingly, each location will be identified first by pyramid owner, then by room, wall, section and register, and column number. For example, in the tomb of Neith, PT 23 is located at Nt/S/Ne B i 1-4: Neith (Nt), Sarcophagus Chamber (S), North wall east end (/Ne), section B register i (B i), columns 1 – 4. For the purposes of this study, the original line numbers which appear in the older publications of Jéquier have been omitted, but can easily be found within Allen's *New Concordance* under the appropriate spell.

All spells will be referred to with the conventional prefix PT (Pyramid Text). However, the discovery of new texts in recent years has prompted the implementation of further identifying spell numbers beyond the "Spruch" set out by Sethe in *Die altägyptischen Pyramidentexte* (1908 – 1910), and the "Utterances" (following Sethe) numbered by Faulkner in *The Ancient Egyptian Pyramid Texts* (1969). Both Allen and MafS employ differing numbering systems to account for these new texts. Thus, to differentiate, the following prefixes will be used:

fPT	Indicates a *Pyramid Text* (Utterance) as numbered by Faulkner, *AEPT*.
PT *	Indicates a *Pyramid Text* as numbered by Allen in *New Concordance*.
sPT	Indicates a *Pyramid Text* as numbered by MafS in Mathieu, *Pepy Ier*.[1]

[1] Following Hays, *Organization*, xxvii – xxix.

Spell location codes are as follows:

SOURCES

Kings

W	Unis
T	Teti
P	Pepy I
M	Merenre I
N	Pepy II (Neferkare)

Queens

AII	Ankhenespepy II
Nt	Neith
Wd	Wedjebten
Ip	Iput II
B	Behenu

ROOMS

S	Sarcophagus Chamber[2]
P	The passageway leading from the Sarcophagus Chamber to Antechamber
A	Antechamber
Ser	Serdab
C	Corridor leading north from the Antechamber
Cs	Corridor, South End (=/C post)
Cm	Corridor, Middle (=/C med)
Cn	Corridor, North End (=/C ant)
V	Vestibule
APs	Ascending passage, south end (=/D post)
APn	Ascending Passage, north end (=/D ant)

[2] Denoted B (Burial Chamber) by Allen, and F (Chambre Funéraire) by MafS.

WALLS, SECTIONS AND REGISTERS

/E	East Wall
/Eg	East Wall, Gable
/N	North Wall
/Ne	North Wall, East End
/Nw	North Wall, West End
/S	South Wall
/Se	South Wall, East End
/Sw	South Wall, West End
/W	West Wall
/Wg	West Wall, Gable
h	Indicates a horizontal register (e.g. M/A/Wh)
A – C	Sections
i – v	Registers

Abbreviations.

AEO	Gardiner, *Ancient Egyptian Onomastica* I – II.
ASAE	Annales du service des antiquités de l'Égypte
BACE	Bulletin of the Australian Centre for Egyptology
BD.	Book of the Dead
BdE	Bibliotheque d'etude, Institude francais d'archeologie orientale.
BIFAO	Bulletin de l'Institut Français d'Archéologie Orientale
CT.	Coffin Text.
EES	Egyptian Exploration Society, London.
EG	Gardiner, *Egyptian Grammar*.
FWb	Kahl, *Frühägyptischen Wörterbuch* I – III.
UEE	UCLA Encyclopaedia of Egyptology
GM	Göttinger Miszellen
GT	Emery, *Great Tombs of the First Dynasty* I – II.
HPBM	Hieratic Papyrus from the British Museum.
IÄF	Kaplony, *Die Inschriften der ägyptischen Frühzeit* I – III.
IFAO	Institut français d'archéologie orientale
JARCE	Journal of the American Research Centre in Egypt
JEA	Journal of Egyptian Archaeology
JNES	Journal of Near Eastern Studies
JSSEA	Journal of the Society of the Study of Egyptian Antiquities (SSEA)
LÄ	Lexikon der Ägyptologie.
LD	Lepsius. *Denkmäler aus Ägypten und Äthiopien*.
LGG	Leitz, *Lexikon der ägyptischen Götter und Götterbezeichnungen*, I – VIII.
LingAeg	Lingua Aegyptica
MafS	Mission Archéologique Française de Saqqarah
MDAIK	Mitteilungen des Deutschen Archäologischen Instituts, Abteilung Kairo
MMA	Metropolian Museum of Art
MMJ	Metropolitan Museum Journal
OMRO	Oudheidkundige Mededelingen uit het Rijksmuseum van Oudheden
Or.	Orientalia. Commentarii periodici Pontificii instituti biblici, Nova Series

PT.	Pyramid Text.
RdE	Revue d'Égyptologie
Rec. Trav.	Recueil de traveaux relatifs à la philologie et à l'archéologie égyptiennes et assyriennes
RT	Petrie. *The Royal Tombs of the First Dynasty* I – II.
SAK	Studien zur Altägyptischen Kultur
SSEA	Journal of the Society of the Study of Egyptian Antiquities
Urk	Sethe, *Urkunden des Alten Reichs. Abteilung* I.
Wb	Erman and Grapow, *Wörterbuch der aegyptischen Sprache*, Band 1 – VII.
ZÄS	Zeitschrift für ägyptische Sprache und Altertumskunde.